

ENGLISH **LIVE**

13

COMPREHENSION & VOCABULARY

UPSC / BANK PO / SSC / OTHERS

SESSION - 13

25th January, 2017



Globalisation's new spokesman

President Xi Jinping's message to the World Economic Forum in Davos was timely and perhaps visionary as well, in this time of extraordinary global uncertainty. It is no surprise if, as in the case of German Chancellor Angela Merkel's potential leadership of the Western alliance, questions have arisen at this juncture about Mr. Xi's willingness to take up cudgels on behalf of broader internationalism and against the rising tide of inward-looking nationalism. His address at the opening plenary before captains of business and industry could not have been a more robust and reassuring defence of the current world economic order, perceived to be at its most fragile in the post-War era with the election of Donald Trump as U.S. President. Foremost is Mr. Xi's caution against attempts to prevent the free flow of goods, services, capital and people as running counter to the historical trend. It is tempting to interpret this remark as a pointed rebuke to growing calls for economic protectionism at a time when a slump in world trade underpins slow economic growth. Not to be missed also is the categorical support he expressed for the swift enforcement of the Paris accord on climate change. Mr. Xi reiterated the call for a reform of global economic governance structures, to reflect the contribution of the emerging and developing countries. His plea for more inclusive representation is in contrast to the unprecedented attacks mounted against post-War institutions in the same countries that crafted their original architecture.

Mr. Xi fundamentally rejected the stance that seeks to lay the blame for the current challenges at the doorstep of globalisation. The tragic effects of mass migration, he said, have their roots in the recent wars and regional conflicts, rather than in economic globalisation. His diagnosis of Europe's challenges on this front could not entirely be faulted, even if it is largely true that the developing countries have reaped most of the benefits of economic mobility, rather than having to deal with the difficulties of immigration. There may be arguments over the modes and methods of managing the political fallout from globalisation. But there is no denying the mounting and demonstrable evidence that the post-Cold War era of open economies has brought unprecedented prosperity and income redistribution around the world. Mr. Xi's case for globalisation is the most forceful such statement by a Chinese leader yet. For long Beijing has been accused of not taking on the burdens of a leadership role commensurate with its economic and strategic power. The changing world order may have left it with no option but to step up to the podium. It also turns the mirror on Beijing, demanding of it a lot more action to back its own words.

THE HINDU

24th January 2017



DISCUSSION ON
25th Jan (today)



DISCUSSION ON
27th Jan (Friday)

BusinessLine

TUESDAY, JANUARY 24, 2017

Letter and spirit

Transparency is the cornerstone of a robust democracy. The Government should lead by example in embracing the RTI Act

An analysis by this paper found that government agencies and institutions are increasingly finding ways to decline information sought under the Right to Information Act (RTI), 2005. The experience of citizens in using the RTI to access information has been largely less than satisfactory. Essentially, the Government and its agencies are finding ways to ensure that the RTI Act becomes an ineffective tool available to the citizens, thus defeating the very purpose for which it was enacted in the first place. It is unfortunate that a law that would have helped lower corruption in public offices and increase transparency in the functioning of government and thus help improve governance has become hostage to political and bureaucratic insecurity. Section 8(1) of the RTI Act together with its clauses have often been misused to deny information requests. This sweeping provision allows the government to deny any information that it perceives to be prejudicial to the sovereignty and integrity of the country, its security, strategic and economic interests or lead to incitement of an offence and would disproportionately divert resources of the public authority.

This is a pity. The RTI Act has helped expose large scams at the central and State level in the past. The Adarsh Housing Society scam, which led to resignation of the then Maharashtra chief minister Ashok Chavan, the Commonwealth Games scam and even the 2G scam were exposed as the result of RTI applications. But such exposes also had unintended consequences. Decision making in the Government came to a standstill particularly during the UPA government's second term. Scams exposed by RTI Act queries gave a handle to opposition parties to attack the ruling alliance and precipitate its downfall.

The RTI Act was revolutionary and designed to be more effective than the Freedom of Information Act enacted by the NDA government in 2002. The Act empowered citizens to hold public functionaries accountable for their actions. It held the promise of cleaning up governance, but that hope proved short-lived. Political parties ensured that they were not covered under the purview of the RTI Act through an amendment in 2013 and therefore were not answerable for their actions to ordinary citizens. Dedicated RTI activists have been verbally and physically abused, and some have even been killed. The government needs to accept that some discomfiture may be the inevitable outcome of any effective use of the Act, but the benefits — by way of changing how politicians, bureaucrats and lower level functionaries conduct themselves and the resultant improvement in governance standards — far outweigh the trouble. Any government that is committed to democratic values should improve transparency and be more accountable to the people it ostensibly exists to serve. It needs to take the lead in setting the right example by embracing the RTI Act in letter and spirit.

LIVE

BusinessLine

24th January 2017

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- It is no surprise if, as in the case of German Chancellor Angela Merkel's potential leadership of the Western alliance, questions have arisen at this juncture about Mr. Xi's willingness to **take up cudgels on behalf** of broader internationalism and against the rising **tide** of inward-looking nationalism.
- His address at the opening **plenary** before captains of business and industry could not have been a more **robust** and reassuring defence of the current world economic order, perceived to be at its most **fragile** in the post-War era with the election of Donald Trump as U.S. President.
- **Foremost** is Mr. Xi's caution against attempts to prevent the free flow of goods, services, capital and people as running **counter** to the historical trend.
- It is tempting to interpret this remark as a pointed **rebuttal** to growing calls for economic protectionism at a time when a **slump** in world trade **underpins** slow economic growth.
- Not to be missed also is the **categorical** support he expressed for the **swift** enforcement of the Paris accord on climate change. Mr. Xi **reiterated** the call for a reform of global economic governance structures, to reflect the contribution of the emerging and developing countries.
- His **plea** for more inclusive representation is in **contrast** to the **unprecedented** attacks mounted against post-War institutions in the same countries that crafted their original architecture.
- Mr. Xi fundamentally rejected the **stance** that seeks to lay the blame for the current challenges at the doorstep of globalisation. The **tragic** effects of mass migration, he said, have their roots in the recent wars and regional conflicts, rather than in economic globalisation.
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- For long Beijing has been accused of not taking on the burdens of a leadership role **commensurate** with its economic and strategic power. The changing world order may have left it with no option but to step up to the podium. It also turns the mirror on Beijing, demanding of it a lot more action to back its own words.



GLOBALISATION & LIBERALISATION



USA



EU



The process of removing this barrier is **liberalization**

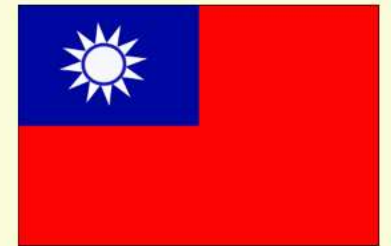
If the barrier is removed, it leads to **globalization**



CHINA



INDIA



TAIWAN



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Visionary



A.P.J Abdul Kalam
is a great **visionary**.



Steve Jobs is a great
visionary.



Visionary

A person who has the ability to imagine how something will develop in the future.



Extraordinary



Reliance
jio

Reliance Jio in its **extraordinary** meeting took a decision to extend free data services for 3 more months



Union Cabinet in its **extraordinary** meeting took a decision with regard to demonetization

Extraordinary

Very unusual, special, unexpected, or strange



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Cudgel



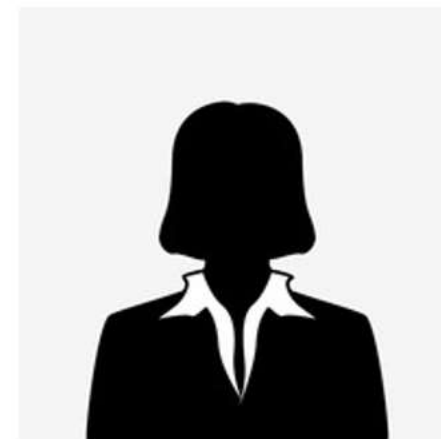
Cudgel

Short, heavy stick used for hitting people



Take up the cudgels

Donald Trump
has **taken up the**
cudgels for
protectionism



I **cudged** my brain to
remember her name

Take up the
cudgels

To join in a dispute, to
defend oneself or
another strongly

Cudgel one's
brain

To think hard about a
problem



Tide



There are rising **tide** of protests for Kambala

Tide

Rise and fall of the sea, normally twice in a day

Tide

A noticeable change of situation / behavior



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His address at the opening *plenary* before captains of business and industry could not have been a more *robust* and reassuring defence of the current world economic order, perceived to be at its most *fragile* in the post-War era with the election of Donald Trump as U.S. President.



Plenary



The **plenary** session of UN Security Council
was held recently

Plenary

A meeting where all the members of a group or organization are
present



Robust

*The Indian economy is
robust*



*SBI is quite a
robust
organization*

Robust

Strong / healthy / unlikely to fail



Fragile



Fragile

Easily damaged, broken or harmed



The **fragile** global economy is further under pressure because of protectionism

Fragile

Easily damaged, harmed



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GLOBALISATION & LIBERALISATION



USA



EU



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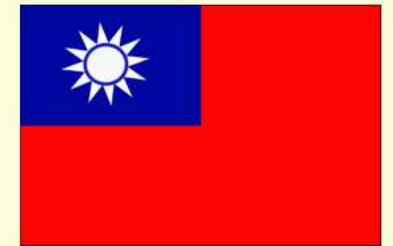
If the barrier is removed, it leads to **globalization**



CHINA



INDIA



TAIWAN



Foremost



Quality education to all the citizens is the
foremost priority

Foremost

Most important or best, leading



Counter



Counter



Proliferation of arrack shops
near national highways is
counter to road safety

Counter

One that is opposite



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It is tempting to interpret this remark as a pointed *rebuttal* to growing calls for economic protectionism at a time when a *slump* in world trade *underpins* slow economic growth.



Rebuke

The girl received a stern **rebu**ke from the principal, as she is always late to the classes



Rebuke

To speak angrily to someone, because of disapproval of what they have said / done



Slump

The property prices have
slumped dramatically,
subsequent to
demonetization



Slump

Sudden reduction in value / quantity



Underpinning



Underpinning

Strengthening the foundation of an existing building or other structure



Underpin

Various new products
launched by Microsoft will
underpin the company's
recovery



Underpin

To give support to something or provide the starting point from
which something can develop



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Not to be missed also is the *categorical* support he expressed for the *swift* enforcement of the Paris accord on climate change. Mr. Xi *reiterated* the call for a reform of global economic governance structures, to reflect the contribution of the emerging and developing countries.



Categorical

The **categorical** statement
on all the aspects of
remonetisation is the need
of the hour



Categorical

Without doubt / without possibility of being changed



Swiftly

He reacted **swiftly**
to correct his
mistakes



Swiftly

Without any delay / in very short time



Reiterate

The Prime Minister **reiterated** several times that the Govt's goal is to see corruption-free India



Reiterate

To say something again, several times



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His *plea* for more inclusive representation is in *contrast* to the *unprecedented* attacks mounted against post-War institutions in the same countries that crafted their original architecture.



Plea

Obama had made emotional **plea** several times to stop racism and also to put an end to gun culture



Plea

An urgent and emotional request



Contrast

The blouse is in quite a
contrast to the saree



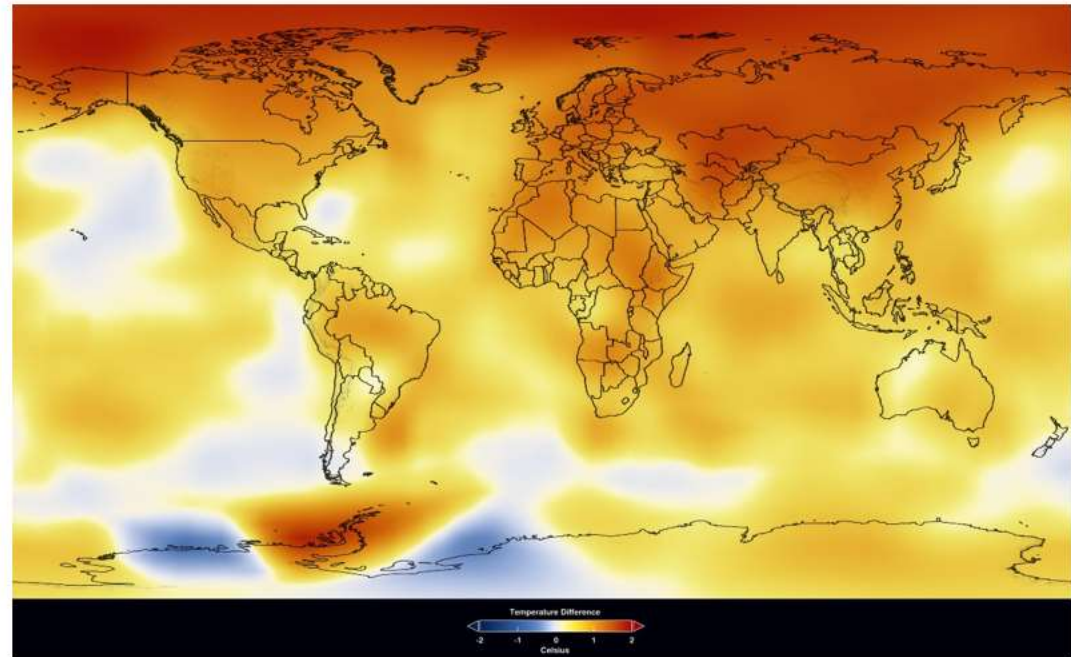
Contrast

Obvious difference between two or more things



Unprecedented

The hallmark of 21st century is **unprecedented** rise in global temperatures



Unprecedented

Never happened / existed in the past



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Stance

The Govt. took tough
stance against terrorism



Stance

A particular way of thinking about something, when they are expressed publicly



Tragic

Bomb explosion in Iraq
resulted in **tragic** loss of
lives



Tragic

Very sad, sometimes involving death or suffering



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His diagnosis of Europe's challenges on this front could not entirely be faulted, even if it is largely true that the developing countries have *reaped* most of the benefits of economic mobility, rather than having to deal with the difficulties of immigration.



Reap



Rooftop farmers **reaped** a rich harvest

Reap

To cut and collect grain



The shareholders **reaped** the benefits of boom in IT stocks

Reap

To make a large amount of money / profit



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Fallout

The **fallout** of the global crisis is being prolonged across the world



Fallout

The bad things that happen after a particular event



Mounting

The **mounting** NPAs is the biggest challenge for public sector banks



State Bank of India

THE BANKER TO EVERY INDIAN



बैंक ऑफ़ बड़ौदा
Bank of Baroda

Mounting

Gradually increasing



Demonstrable

The slowdown in IT sector is **demonstrative** of more and more automation

Information
Technology



Demonstrable

Able to be proved



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Commensurate

The salary must be
commensurate with the
skills and experience



Commensurate

Correct and suitable amount



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